

Child and Co.

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THE HERITAGE of FLEET STREET

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Child & Co. was a famous bank on Fleet Street in London. It began in the 1600s as a goldsmith's shop owned by Robert Blanchard and later run by Francis Child. Francis made the bank successful and well known. He worked for King William III and lent money to the government. The bank also worked closely with lawyers and Oxford colleges, which helped it survive difficult times.

The bank stayed in the same family for many years. In the late 1700s, Sarah Anne Child ran away to marry the Earl of Westmoreland because her father would not allow the marriage. Later, her daughter Sarah Sophia inherited the bank. She became Lady Jersey and managed the bank until 1867.

The bank continued to grow and rebuilt its building in the 1800s. In 1924, it was sold to another bank.

Child & Co. finally closed in 2022 after more than 350 years in business.

